

Building for ActCAD, or building for the world?

A directors briefing — for discussion

Working brand TejasCAD · pending TM clearance

ITC pricing is what we actually pay. Our own projections are illustrative.

The decision on the table

- We are **already** moving ActCAD off IntelliCAD — **that continues either way**
- The question is one level up:

Build it only for ActCAD — or as a platform other CAD vendors license under their own brand?

- Every seam we build for ActCAD is **what a platform needs anyway**
- A specific market: **~40 ITC members** · **~200 vertical ISVs** · BIM-lite startups
- **“Can we build it” is settled** — Phase 0 ships today

Phase 0 — what already ships

Six weeks · ~207 commits · 13+ drops to the ActCAD team

- **Real customer DWGs open in the browser** — WASM and ODA inWEB, both live
- **Full 14-mode osnap suite**, measure, count, CSV + Excel export
- **250K entities at 61 fps** · regen 17× faster · instant zoom-extents
- **3D orbit, ViewCube, layouts, paper-space viewports**
- **DWG ↔ DWG and PDF comparison**, colour plotting, batch print, markups
- **Windows MSI shipping** · macOS CI green · Android prototype
- **594/594 tests green** · read-only guarantee intact

Faster than ActCAD on many customer files — and well ahead of IntelliCAD's viewer and ODA's own.

Still owed: customer-hardware perf baseline · public launch

Architecture for the editor

Some ODA features are not exposed to the web stack.

- **Now → viewer launch** — stay on Rust/Tauri + WASM. Ship it.
- **After launch — migrate the full editor to Qt + C++ native**
- where the missing ODA surface becomes available
- where the ActCAD team wants to be long term
- **The web viewer** — folds into the Qt stack, or stays on Rust/Tauri
- **decide with data during the migration**

The platform seams live in the C++ core — whichever shell wraps them.

The case against — at full strength

- **We are a CAD company, not a platform company**
- **It distracts from what matters** — the real cost is management attention
- **The money is not transformational**
- **We would be arming competitors**
- **Members will constrain our roadmap**
- **Nobody has asked for this** — zero members, zero LOIs
- **ITC members are sticky** — twenty years in
- **We do not have the team** — it has to be hired from scratch

Five of those eight are substantially correct.

Why we still think yes

- **Not a platform company** — nothing before month 24 requires becoming one
- **Distracts from ActCAD** — *partly conceded*, attention is the real cost
- **Money is modest** — *conceded*, not a reason on its own
- **Arming competitors** — gated, **or we simply don't sell that tier**
- **Roadmap constraint** — *conceded*, **the one that worries us most**
- **No demand proven** — *fully conceded*, hence the kill switch
- **No team** — *conceded*, but **we need that team for ActCAD anyway**

Building multi-tenant makes ActCAD better even if no member ever signs.

- Forces a clean core, a real plugin API, configuration over hard-coding
- **Retrofitting later means reworking six of ten modules**

Who builds it

- **TejasCAD hires** — dev · QA · dev support
- **ActCAD's team does what it is best at** — domain expertise, verticals, IRX, product judgement
- **ActCAD's sales is unchanged** — same team, same customers
- **Members support their own customers** — never us

That team is the engine team. ActCAD-new needs those people either way.

- The platform doesn't create the cost — **it decides who employs them, and who else helps pay**

The kill switch

- **Month 12** — 8–10 qualified member conversations, or **stop outbound**
- **Month 24, at ActCAD GA** — **2 signed LOIs, or we stop entirely**
- no platform entity · no partner obligations · no second set of books
- **Before any vertical-tier sale** — if it threatens ActCAD, **don't sell it**

If month 24 fails we lose 3–6 engineer-months — on architecture we'd defend on ActCAD's own merits.

- And we still keep a clean engine, a real plugin API, a proper licensing layer

The two paths

Engine work	Same	Same
Ship date	~24 months	Same
Extra cost	—	3–6 engineer-months
Revenue	ActCAD	+ member fees, marketplace, royalties
Exit	One product	A second saleable asset
If it fails	—	We still shipped a great ActCAD

A no forecloses one thing that is hard to reopen — the architecture. Everything else can wait three years.

What we pay IntelliCAD today

- ~\$100K a year — membership and extras
- **No per-seat royalty to ITC**
- **\$15–20 per sale** — component royalties, ACIS and others
- **AI: ~\$7–8K extra** — experimental
- **Android viewer: ~\$8K extra** — weak
- **Mac, web app, web editor: not available.** Windows-tied.

And what we get is ~a million lines of source — not a product.

- A codebase to staff, fork and re-merge on every uptake, **before selling a seat**

What we'd give that ITC does not

Deliverable	~1M lines of source	A product you configure
Engine upkeep	Yours, forever	Ours
Bug fixes	You fix — work reaches rivals	We fix — you just receive
Your plugins	Tangled with engine patches	Stay entirely yours
Releases	Annual, coordinated	Rolling — ship when ready
Reach	Windows	Win · Mac · Linux · web · Android
AI	\$8K experiment	Included
Licensing	Buy your own	Included, platform-blind

The consortium gave members shared ownership of a codebase and sole responsibility for running it. We carry the responsibility instead.

What we deliver, and what we'd charge

Three tiers

- **Core** — engine, DWG fidelity, white-label shell, licensing, **AI**
- **Plus** — + **web app**, **Mac**, **Android**, marketplace
- **Complete** — + **our verticals** (Arch · Mech · Elec · BIM · GIS)

MEMBER'S SEATS	CORE	PLUS	COMPLETE
Under 5,000	\$45K	\$65K	\$90K
5,000–20,000	\$80K	\$110K	\$150K
20,000–50,000	\$130K	\$170K	\$220K
50,000+	\$190K	\$240K	\$300K

- **Ramped 50 / 75 / 100%** over the migration years
- **Component royalties at cost** · **AI metered** above an allowance
- **The vertical tier is a decision, not a price** — it arms possible competitors

What this could become

	CONSERVATIVE	BASE	AGGRESSIVE
Members by Y7	5	12	20
Blended fee	~\$70K	~\$110K	~\$170K
Platform ARR	~\$425K	~\$1.7M	~\$4.3M
Profit	~\$290K	~\$1.2M	~\$3.1M
Value at 6–8×	not saleable	~\$10–13M	~\$26–34M

A profitable adjacent business line — not a venture-scale company.

- Materially bigger needs **60–100 members**, direct-to-end-user, or **the 3D product**
- **Later questions — not assumptions**

Funding

- **Promoter seed, now → Y2 — \$1–2M**
- the increment on an engine already funded
- **Optional strategic round, Y4–5 — \$5–10M**
- from a plausible acquirer, **to set a floor**
- **Exit, Y6–7 — \$30–50M**

What forces price up is competition between buyers — not a prior round.

- At ~70% margins this **self-funds from year 3**
- **Take the round for tension, not for cash**

What we are asking

In-principle approval

And to open three discussions

- **Corporate structure**
- **Capital requirement**
- **The team required to make this happen**

Nothing else is decided today — no capital commitment, no incorporation, no announcement, no change to how ActCAD runs.